

DEDICATED TO
MORGAN D. KENNER

SPECIAL
POINTS OF
INTEREST:

- Missouri Pioneer Family
- Arkansas Pioneer Family
- Kenner Cemetery
- Kenner Church
- Eight Generations

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Kenner Chronicle

VOLUME 1, ISSUE 1

SUMMER 2013

The Honorable Rev. Elias Housen Kenner

Dear Morgan, I wish you to know something of your ancestors and the noble name that you carry. The founder of the Kenner side of the Missouri Kenner - Latham Family, was the Honorable Rev. Elias Housen Kenner. (The first Kenner in MO, was Elias's great uncle Francis Kenner who arrived in 1802/1803 before MO was a state.)

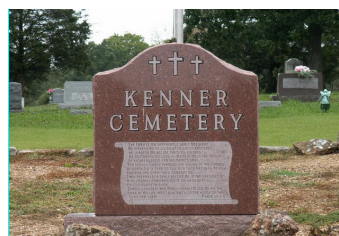
Elias was born in Hawkins County, TN on 24 March, 1817. He was the son of William Kenner and Elizabeth (daughter of Isaac Mendenhall from northern Scotland).

His life was a struggle. His mother apparently died shortly after his birth and his father died when he was only 12 years old. It is unknown who raised him after his father's death.

Family history states that he served under General Wool in the Seminole Wars. On 23 June 1842, he married Clarinda (daughter of James Latham) near Tishomingo, MS. In 1843 he followed his father-in-law to Pulaski County, MO. Becoming one of **Missouri's Pioneering Families**. Their first child Margaret was born here in 1844. He was poor, only having a good wife and an honorable name. In the 1850 U.S. Census, he lists his occupation as farm laborer, having no land of his own.

Then on 10 June 1857 he purchased 80 acres of land in Maries County. Followed on 1 Sept

1857 of an additional 240 acres. This land was valued at \$2,000 in 1860 for which he paid taxes in 1863, 1867 and 1878. On this land he built a farm, but he also



Kenner Cemetery
17996 Maries Road 505
Dixon MO 65459

built Kenner School, Kenner Cemetery and Kenner Methodist Church (the 2nd oldest Methodist church in Maries County) of which he was the Pastor. He performed the marriage of his nephew Rev. George Washington Latham. He was also elected Justice of the Peace and served as a judge.

Then in the 1870's he met with financial reversal, lost his eyesight, his commissions as Justice of the Peace and Minister. On 5 April 1873 he deeded Kenner Church & Cemetery to the United Dry Creek Baptist Church. (Today it is known as Kenner Church of God.) They left Maries County and all their hard work and headed for Arkansas. They first settled in Ripley County, MO. Where he is listed in the 1877 Personal Tax List.

He is listed in the 1880 U.S. Census, living in Union township, with his son Cavester who was a school teacher. Finally, with his 2 sons Charles and James, he moved to Warm Springs township in Randolph County, AR. Becoming one of **Arkansas's Pioneering Families**. Where he died on 16 Jan 1897 and is buried in Macedonia Cemetery.

He had 11 children: Elias Housen (E.H.C.), Margaret, Nancy Jane, John, James, Cavester, Samuel, Charles and 3 others that died young.

Nancy Jane married Thomas Wilson and had 11 children: Thomas, James, Mary, Simon, Margaret (who married George Doyle), Millie, Ellsworth, Elizabeth (who married Edwin Uline), Zephia, (who married James Simpson), John and Roy.

Cavester married Manerva Holland and had a son Wiley.

John married Laura Linn and had 2 children: Mauril and Robert.

Samuel married Arretta King and had 5 children: Ollie, Lily, Almus, William and Raymond.

James married Rosa Cantwell and had 8 children: Effie, Pearl, Neil, Tom, Elias, Clara, Bernice and Gladys.

Charles married Samantha Langley and had 4 children: Aubrey (who married Hester Johnson and had: Tom, Rena, Manford and Sherman), Claude, Roy and Lessie.

Rev. E.H.C. Kenner



Lester Kenner



Debra Cain

Top row left is Rev.
George Kenner and
seated is Rev. E.H.C.
Kenner

The Rev. E.H.C. Kenner was born 24 Nov 1849 in Maries County. Where on April 1868 he married Matilda (daughter of Isaac Miller). Like his father he became a Minister but followed his mother's denomination and became a Circuit Rider for the Missionary Baptist Association. One Baptist publication described him as *"a shrewd and brilliant man, a great debater, noted for his wit and for his sermons on Baptist doctrine. Many looked upon him as a champion of Baptist orthodoxy and he came to the place of acknowledge leadership among the group that was beginning to known as Landmark Baptist."*

He un-successfully ran for the Missouri House of Representatives on the Republican ticket but later refused to vote for Republican President William Taft because he was a Unitarian. He died on 29 April

1928 and is buried in Black Creek Missionary Baptist Church Cemetery. E.H.C. had 11 children: Johnney, Harvey, Louise, George, Clarinda, Wiley, Joseph, Ethel, Lulia, Charles and Jesse.

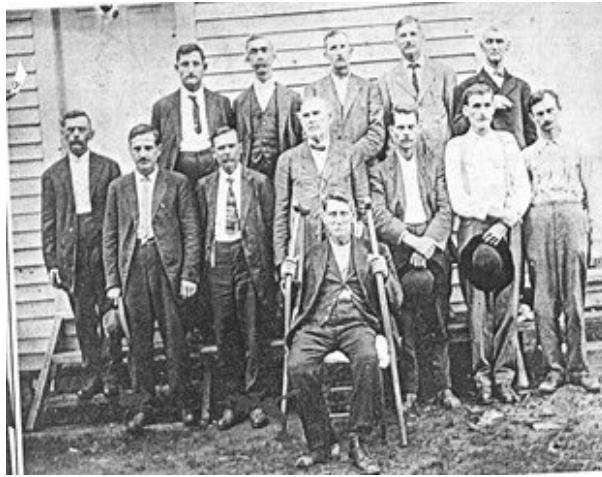
Joseph married Ella Ruth and had 2 children: Joseph and Nadine.

Jesse married Ollie and had 2 children: Mildred and Nancy. Nancy married Ted Burton and had 2 children: Randy and Debra. Randy had Kristina, Jesse and Seth.

Debra had 6 children: Joshua Boyd (married Breanna and had 2 sons: Jaxon and Jordan), then married a Cain and had

Brieanne (who had: Triniti, Liliahna and Kaiden Douglass), Zachary (who had Zayden), Brittany (who had 2 girls: Nevaeh and Aniyah Twitchell), Gabriel (who had Bentley) and Samantha. This makes Debra the current Goldstar Mother of the Kenner - Latham Family.

Charles married Ethel Dixon and had 2 children: Lester and Norma. As of this publication Lester is 101 years old: the oldest living descendent and the Kenner - Latham Family Patriarch. He served for six years in the service: first in the National Guard and then U.S. Army stationed in the South Pacific for two years during WWII. He has done extensive traveling since he turned 90: Australia to hold a Koala; riding an elephant in Thailand at 91; going on Safari at 98. He now lives with his daughter Dr. Carole Kenner who is the Dean at North-eastern University. Carole is an author / editor of many text books in the field of neonatal/perinatal/pediatric nursing.



Rev. George T. Kenner

The Rev. George T. Kenner was born on 5 Jan 1872 in Maries County. On 21 Sept 1890 married Martha (daughter of Allen Staton). Like his father he too was a Circuit Rider for the Missionary Baptist Association. The Doniphan

newspaper the Prospect News says *"Preacher Kenner was well known for baptizing people even in real cold weather. From 25-30 people would be "saved" at one time and baptized in the nearest body of water - regardless of the temperature."* Kenner Spring Branch on Cane Creek is named after him.

His first church was Black

Creek (where his father is buried). Then Rocky Point, Lone Star, Springhill and Center Hill.

George died 10 Oct 1933 and is buried in Ripley County.

George had 7 children: Bessie, Frank, Perry, Logan, George, Clarence and Mary.

Black Creek Missionary
Baptist Church
Poplar Bluff MO



Perry L. Kenner

Perry was born 4 Nov 1895 in Black Creek, MO. He did not follow in the family tradition of becoming a Minister, instead he chose a simpler life of a barber and small business owner.

On 3 Dec 1915 he married Lillian Spillman in Kirksville, MO. On 24 Sept 1916 Richard was born in Cedar Rapids, IA. However the marriage did not last and Richard went to live with his grandparents Elisha and Mary in Twin Falls, ID. On 20 Feb 1943 he enlisted in the Army in Los Angeles, CA to serve in WWII as a Private. At this time his marital status was separated with dependents. He was released on 2 July 1945. On 15 June 1963 he re-married to Virginia Harper but the marriage did not last, divorcing in July 1970. He moved to Middleton ID, where he spent the rest of his life, dying on 26 Sept 1999.

On 29 Oct 1929 Perry re-married to Ina (daughter of Jesse Jerome Seymore) in Poplar Bluff, MO. Moving to what was then the edge of town on Davis Street just at the end on Main Street. Perry had a barber shop downtown. However after he retired his clientele still showed up at his home and he would cut their hair in the kitchen. After-a-while he decided to build a barber shop next to the carport and people continued to get their hair cuts for years to come. Even I had my hair cut as child by grandpa. I remember grandpa in his 70's walking on stilts and riding a bicycle backwards. Perry died on 19 June 1991 in Poplar Bluff. He is buried in the Poplar Bluff Cemetery. Perry and Ina had 3 children: Mary Jane, Jerome and Paul.

On 4 June 1948 Mary Jane married Ira Melton and had a son: Ira who married Sheila Bird. They had 2 children: Loren and Mindy. Mindy married Austin Lampe and has a

little girl, Bella. Loren also has a little girl, Sophia. Mary Jane re-married to Herman Braun. They had 2 children: Charlie (who followed in his grandfathers footsteps and became a lay Pastor with his wife Joyce) and Melanie. Melanie married Joseph Cogswell and has 3 children: Mary (named after Mary Jane), Jared and Katelyn. Mary married Michael Maret and they have 3 girls: Emma, Shelby and Mollie. After a 20 year battle with cancer and 3 weeks after dancing at her son's wedding, Mary Jane died on 3 Sept 1987. She is buried at the Jefferson Barracks National Cemetery in St. Louis, MO.

Paul was a member of the National Guard and married Ruth Bass Rodgers, with her son Jimmie. Together they had 2 more sons: Chris and Michael. Chris had 2 children: Ryan and Ashley who has 3 girls: MaKayla, Alexis and Karen. Michael married Amy Weaver and has a son, Zachary. Jimmie married Danielle and they have 3 children. Paul became the mayor (D) of Winchester, MO. He was a draftsman and designed the Mormon Church and the Welcome Sign, both in Poplar Bluff on Hwy 67 North. Paul died on 15 Nov 1997. (Debra Cain raised her family in the same home Paul designed and raised his family in.)

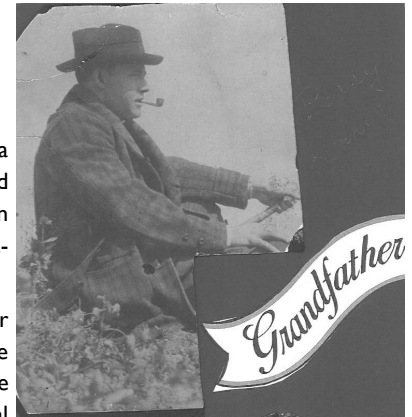
Jerome served in the Navy and married Annette Bower. He opened or administered 3 hospitals in rural Missouri: Herman, Doniphan and Dexter. They have 5 children: Toni, Jeffery, Lisa, David and Eric.

Toni married Dale Kennedy. They have 2 daughters: Nicole and Jaclyn. Nicole married Roman Villasana and has a little girl, Gabriela.

Lisa married Buddy Taylor and had a daughter Lori Beth who has a

little girl, Addison. Lisa re-married to Donald Willis and had a son Sean who married Elizabeth.

I married your mother Lieutenant Tonette Morgan. You were born on your paternal grandfathers birthday and named after your maternal grandfather.



Perry L. Kenner
pictured above.



Top left: Sophia and Bella, part of the 8th generation.



Bottom left:
Gabriela, Nicole, Toni, Roman:
generations 6, 7, 8

Picture below: Chris, Amy, Mike, Jerome, Eric, Loren, Mindy and David



Welcome Sign, Poplar Bluff, MO.



The Kenner Chronicle

<http://davidkenner.wordpress.com/>

<https://www.facebook.com/pages/Kenner-Family/129598733783428>

http://groups.yahoo.com/group/Kenner_Family/

E-mail: Kenner_Family@yahoo.com

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Miscellaneous

The week of 5 Nov 1998 Maries County Gazette contained a genealogical mystery to be solved. The Maries County Historical Society's Cemetery Book for Kenner Cemetery does not list a single Kenner in the index. The question posed, "Where are the KENNER's buried?"

Here is a list of some of the beliefs of Rev. E.H.C. Kenner based upon his autobiography: Missionary; Believers Baptism by immersion; One-cup closed Communion using real wine; Foot-washing; Final preservation of the Saints; Salvation by grace (not works); King James only with

an emphasis on the New Testament (literally translated); Sunday School; Hell Fire; Virgin Birth; Vicarious Atonement; Divinity of Christ; Land-

markism; Congregational autonomy.

"Then let my last words be to all the true and the brave to stand by the Old Ship, keep her sailing and her sails hoisted and her banner unfurled. God forbid that n'er one solid fold should over trail the dust for the lack of loyal hearts and loving hands to uphold and support the truth as it is in Christ Jesus the Lord. For if the truth shall make you free, you are free indeed. Amen."

Rev. E.H.C. Kenner
Benediction



A Kenner Christmas: Lisa, David, Jerome, Annette, Tonette, Elizabeth, Sean, Addison, Morgan and Lori